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Suicide prevention



More than 720 000 people die by suicide every year. For each suicide, there are an estimated 20 suicide attempts.

Suicide can occur at any stage of life and in all regions of the world. In 2021, suicide was the third leading cause of death among 15–29-year-olds globally, and 73% of all suicides happened in low- and middle-income countries. Almost 20% of global suicides were due to pesticide self-poisoning.

While the link between suicide and mental health conditions (in particular, depression and alcohol use disorders) and a previous suicide attempt is well established in high-income countries, many suicides happen impulsively in moments of crisis. Further risk factors for suicide include experience of loss, loneliness, discrimination, relationship dispute, financial problems, chronic pain and illness, violence, abuse, and conflict or other humanitarian emergencies.

Stigma around mental health conditions and suicide means many people thinking about suicide do not seek help. Suicides and suicide attempts have a ripple effect that impacts on families, friends, colleagues, communities and societies.

- **[Suicide: facts and figures globally](#)**
- **[Suicide worldwide in 2021: global health estimates](#)**
- **[LIVE LIFE: an implementation guide for suicide prevention in countries](#)**

Fact sheets



Questions and answers



Databases and tools



Initiatives and groups



Resolutions and decisions



Technical work



News

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11 December 2025_ | Departmental update

New resource on setting up a suicide bereavement support group



11 December 2025_ | Departmental update

New resource to help countries count cases of suicide more accurately





7 November 2025_ | Statement

Joint call to strengthen policy and investment for child and youth mental health and well-being



2 September 2025_ | Departmental update

WHO releases new reports and estimates highlighting urgent gaps in mental health

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Latest publications

1 December 2025

Preventing suicide: a resource for strengthening suicide case registration

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World mental health today: latest data

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Mental health atlas 2024

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20 August 2024

Preventing suicide by phasing out highly hazardous pesticides

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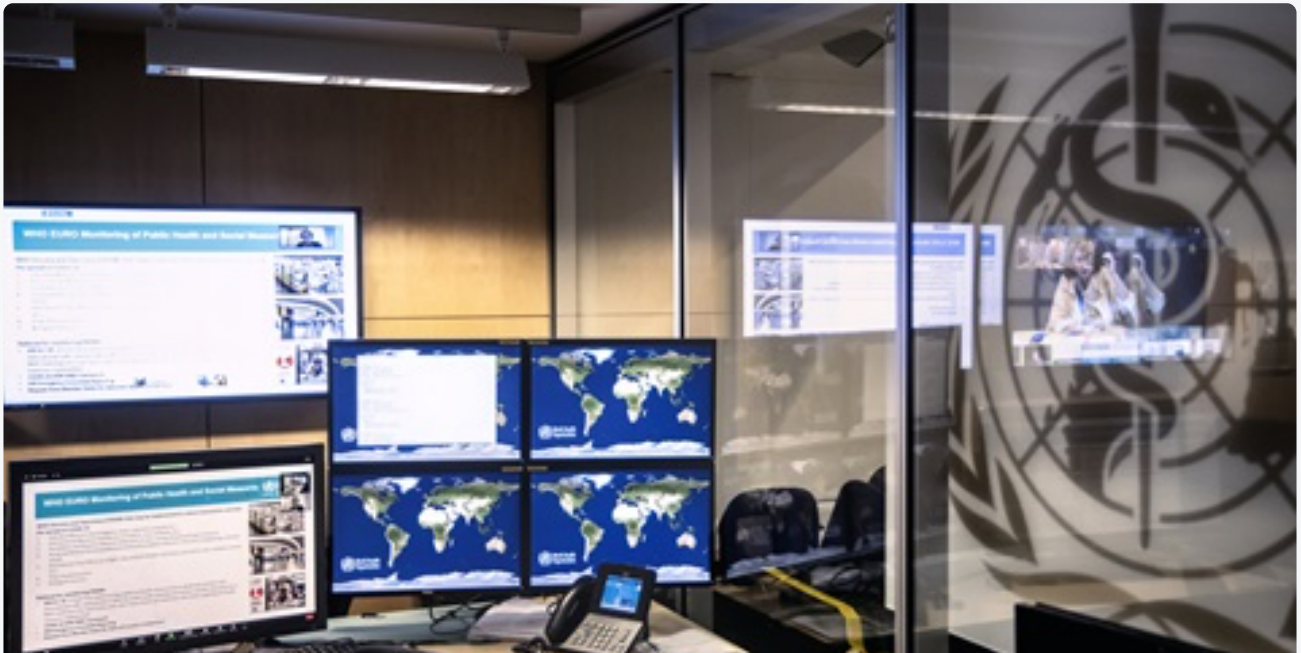
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20 March 2024

Addressing Suicide in Humanitarian Settings, IASC Guidance

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Our work



Monitoring and sharing suicide data and statistics



Advocating for national suicide prevention strategies



Strengthening surveillance of suicide and self-harm

Feature stories

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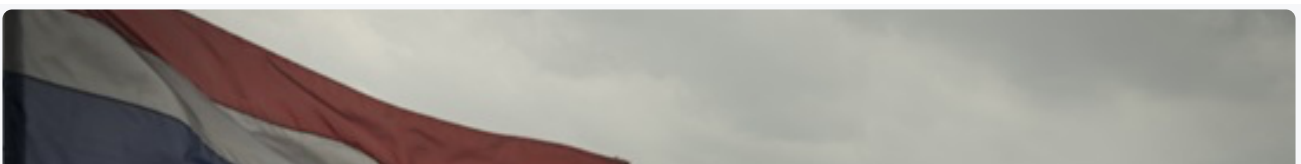
3 September 2026

Awareness activities for suicide prevention among students and young people in Japan



25 August 2025

From early detection to care: how Uruguay is transforming suicide prevention through real-time surveillance





10 September 2024

Suicide prevention in Thailand: A whole-of-society approach



9 September 2024

Suicide prevention in Suriname: strengthening multisectoral collaboration

Infographics

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Infographic

Do you know someone who may be considering suicide?



Infographic

Do you feel like life is not worth living?

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Videos



16 June 2021

Launch of WHO LIVE LIFE - Guide on suicide prevention

 58 minutes



6 December 2020

Suicide prevention: interview with Klas Bergling, father of DJ Tim Bergling aka Avicii



18 November 2020

Preventing suicide and coping with loss



19 February 2020

Preventing suicide at work: information for employers, managers and employees

Events

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World Suicide Prevention Day 2026 - Changing the narrative on suicide

 10 September 2026

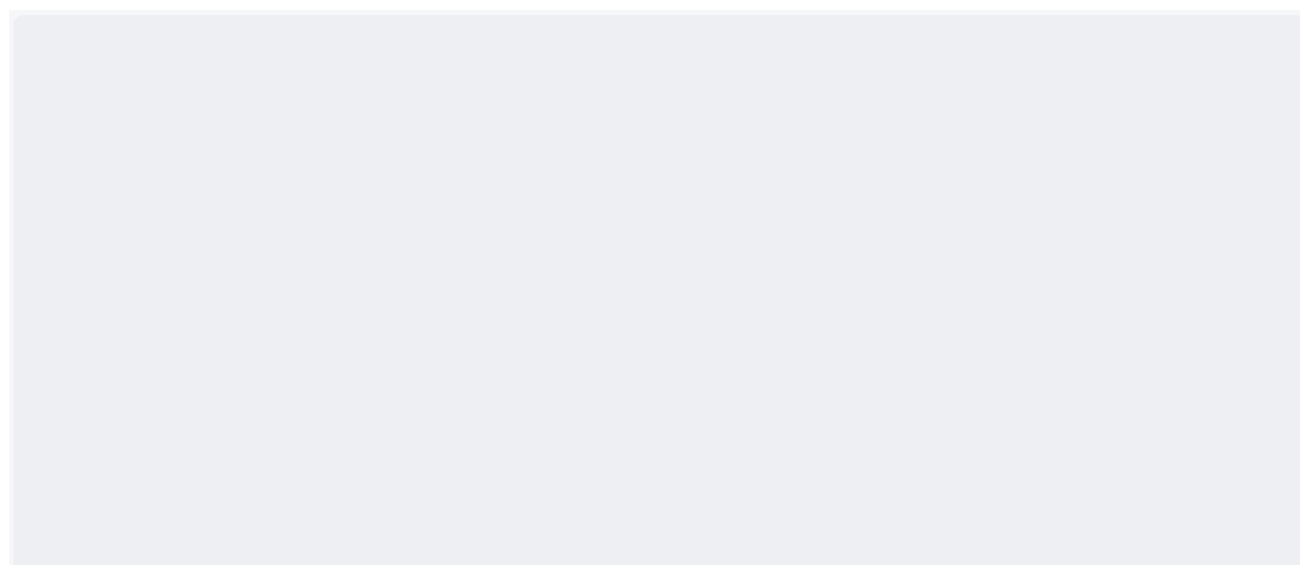
World Suicide Prevention Day 2025 - Changing the narrative on suicide

 10 September 2025

World Suicide Prevention Day 2024 - Changing the narrative on suicide

 10 September 2024

Related health topics



| Populations and demographics

Adolescent health



| Conditions

Depression





| Health and wellbeing

Mental health



| Human behaviour

Violence against women